

INVESTMENT STARTER KIT · \$37

Couples

Investment Starter Kit

From Knowing to Doing

Your Action Plan for Joint Wealth Building. Bridge the gap between financial conversations and real investing.

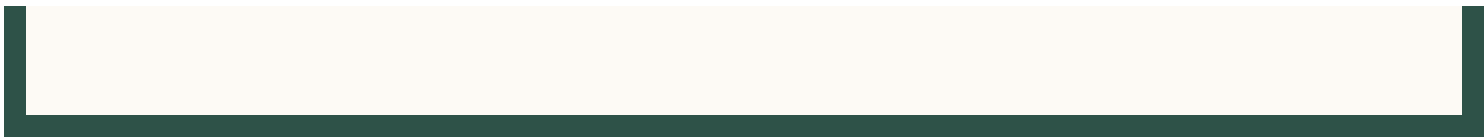
OUR INVESTMENT STARTING POINT

Partner 1	Partner 2
Name _____	Name _____
Current savings (to invest) \$ _____	Target first investment amount \$ _____
Our #1 investing goal this year e.g. Max out both Roth IRAs _____	

⚠ EDUCATIONAL DISCLAIMER

This kit is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice. Consult a licensed financial advisor for guidance specific to your situation. All investment involves risk including potential loss of principal.

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[How-To Guide](#)

Welcome to Your Investment Journey Bridging conversations into action

Why Invest Together?

You've had the conversations. You've dreamed about your future. Now it's time to build it. Investing together is more than a financial decision—it's an act of partnership that creates transparency, aligns your goals, and harnesses the power of compound interest to create wealth that serves your shared vision.

This kit connects directly to Module 2 of your workbook, expanding on the "Priority Ladder" concept with actionable steps, practical tools, and milestone celebrations that keep you motivated along the way.

What's Inside This Kit

Brokerage Account Setup Guide: A step-by-step walkthrough to open your first joint investment account with confidence.

Allocation Cheat Sheets: Three simplified investment strategies to help you decide what to buy, from "set it and forget it" target date funds to a simple 3-fund portfolio.

Retirement Catch-Up Calculator: A practical worksheet to assess your retirement readiness and identify how much more you might need to contribute.

The \$10k Roadmap: Celebrate every milestone as you build your first \$10,000 invested together, with ideas for meaningful celebrations at each step.

Important Disclaimer: This kit is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice. Consider consulting a qualified financial advisor for personalized recommendations based on your specific situation.

Step 1: Choose Your Platform Selecting the right brokerage is your first decision

Your brokerage platform is where your investments will live. Consider factors like ease of use, investment options, fees, and customer service. Here are the top options for your region:

USA Options

Brokerage	Key Features	Best For
Vanguard	Low-cost index funds and ETFs	Passive, long-term investors
Fidelity	Zero-fee funds, great UI/UX	Beginners & active traders alike
Charles Schwab	Excellent customer service	Balanced feature seekers

International Alternatives

Region	Top Recommendations	Global Option
United Kingdom	Vanguard UK, Trading 212, Hargreaves Lansdown	Interactive Brokers (IBKR) Available in 200+ countries
Canada	Questrade, Wealthsimple, TD Direct Investing	
Australia	Vanguard Australia, Pearler, Stake, CommSec	

Step 2: Decide on Account Type Understanding your options

Joint Brokerage Account (Taxable Account)

Owned by both partners, allowing for shared contributions and management. Ideal for saving toward short-to-medium term goals like a down payment or large purchases, or for funds beyond retirement accounts. Profits are subject to capital gains tax.

Individual Retirement Accounts (IRAs/Roth IRAs)

Owned by one individual, but contributions can be made by either spouse. These offer significant tax advantages for retirement savings. It's common for each spouse to have their own IRA or Roth IRA. Annual contribution limits apply.

For most couples starting out: A joint taxable brokerage account is the most straightforward way to pool resources for shared goals outside of retirement accounts.

Step 3: Gather Your Documents What you'll need before applying

Before you begin the online application, ensure you have the following information readily available for both partners:

- 1 Tax ID / Social Security Numbers for both account holders
- 2 Government-issued IDs (Driver's License or Passport) for both partners
- 3 Bank Account Information (Routing and Account Numbers) for funding
- 4 Employer Information (Name and Address) for regulatory purposes

Step 4: The Application Process What to expect

- 1 Select "Open a New Account" and choose a joint brokerage account
- 2 Provide personal information for both account holders
- 3 Answer questions about your investment experience and risk tolerance
- 4 Review and agree to terms and conditions
- 5 Fund your account by linking your bank account (immediately or later)

Step 5: Automate It—The Secret to Consistency Set it and forget it

Once your account is open and funded, set up recurring automatic transfers from your joint checking or savings account. This is arguably the most important step in the entire process. Automating your investments ensures consistency, removes emotion from the decision-making process, and allows you to benefit from dollar-cost averaging—the practice of investing a fixed amount at regular intervals regardless of market conditions.

Even small, regular contributions add up significantly over time. A \$500 monthly contribution invested consistently over 30 years at an average 7% annual return grows to over \$800,000. Consistency is your superpower.

Pro Tip: Schedule your automatic transfer to occur a few days after your paycheck deposits. This ensures funds are available and removes the temptation to spend the money elsewhere.

Your Brokerage Setup Checklist Track your progress

- ☐ Chosen Brokerage Platform: _____
- ☐ Joint Account Opened: _____
- ☐ Bank Account Linked: _____
- ☐ Initial Funding Completed: _____
- ☐ Automatic Transfer Set Up: _____

"What to Actually Buy" Decision Worksheet Turn information into action with this simple 3-step flowchart

Choosing your first investment can feel paralyzing. Use this flowchart to narrow down your options based on your goals and comfort level. Remember: Perfection is the enemy of progress. The most important thing is to start.

Q1: What is your Time Horizon? (When do you need the money?)

Short-Term (< 3-5 Years)

Medium-Term (5-10 Years)

Long-Term (10+ Years)



Q2: What is your Risk Tolerance? (How do you feel about drops?)

Low (Safety First)

Moderate (Balanced)

High (Growth Focus)



Q3: Pick Your Fund Type (The Action Step)

Your Actionable Pick:

Follow the logic below to find your fund...

The Fund Selection Guide

If your horizon is...	And risk is...	Buy this type of fund:
Short-Term	Any	Cash / Money Market: High-yield savings or VMFXX.
Medium-Term	Low/Mod	Balanced (60/40): VSMGX (US), VBAL (CA/AU), V60A (UK).
Long-Term	High	Total World Equity: VT/VTI (US), VWRL (UK), VGS (AU), VEQT (CA).

Decision Checklist:

- ☐ We have identified our time horizon.
- ☐ We agree on our risk tolerance level.
- ☐ We have selected our starting fund: _____

Strategy 1: The "Set It and Forget It" Option Target Date Funds (TDFs)

Target Date Funds are the ultimate hands-off investment. You choose the fund with the year closest to when you plan to retire (e.g., Target Retirement 2055), and the fund automatically adjusts its asset allocation—moving from more aggressive (stocks) to more conservative (bonds)—as you get closer to that date.

Best For: Couples who want a professional to manage their allocation and rebalancing automatically for a very low fee.

Strategy 2: The Simple 3-Fund Portfolio Broad market diversification

A 3-fund portfolio provides exposure to the entire investable market through three low-cost index funds. This strategy is highly diversified, tax-efficient, and easy to manage.

Fund Type	What it Covers	Example (Vanguard)
Total Stock Market	Entire US stock market	VTSAX / VTI
Total International Stock	Non-US stocks (developed & emerging)	VTIAX / VXUS
Total Bond Market	Entire US investment-grade bond market	VBTLX / BND

Assess Your Retirement Readiness

A practical worksheet to identify your gap

1. Desired Annual Retirement Income (in today's dollars):

\$ _____

2. Estimated Social Security/Pension Income (combined):

\$ _____

3. Annual Income Gap to Fill (Line 1 – Line 2):

\$ _____

4. Target Retirement Nest Egg (Line 3 x 25):

\$ _____

Based on the 4% Rule: Multiply your annual gap by 25 to find your target number.

5. Current Combined Retirement Savings:

\$ _____

6. Remaining Gap (Line 4 – Line 5):

\$ _____

Next Step: Use an online retirement calculator for more precise figures based on your specific situation and expected returns.

Your First \$10,000 Invested Together Celebrate every milestone

Reaching your first \$10,000 invested is a significant milestone. It's where the power of compounding starts to become more visible and motivating. This roadmap helps you track your progress and celebrate each step along the way. The next \$10,000 will come faster than you think.

Milestone 1: \$1,000 ✓

The First Step

Congratulations! You've officially started your investing journey. This initial step is often the hardest, but you've done it!

Celebration Idea: Treat yourselves to a nice coffee or a small, meaningful item you've been wanting.

Milestone 2: \$2,500 ✓

Building Momentum

You're building momentum! Your consistent contributions are starting to make a noticeable difference.

Celebration Idea: A special date night, perhaps cooking a favorite meal together at home.

Milestone 3: \$5,000 ✓

Halfway There

Halfway to your first major goal! You're seeing your money work for you. Review your portfolio and discuss any adjustments.

Celebration Idea: A weekend getaway or a small splurge on a shared hobby.

Milestone 4: \$7,500 ✓

The Finish Line Approaches

The finish line is in sight! Your discipline is paying off. Revisit your long-term goals and dreams.

Celebration Idea: Plan a future experience together that your investments are helping to fund.

The Final Milestone Celebrate your achievement

Milestone 5: \$10,000

You've Done It!

Your first \$10,000 invested together is a huge achievement and the beginning of the snowball effect. The next \$10,000 will likely come faster! You've proven that you can work together toward a shared financial goal. This is the foundation of wealth building.

Celebration Idea: A significant experience or purchase you've been saving for, or a donation to a cause you both care about. Make it meaningful.

Your \$10K Progress Tracker Fill in as you reach each milestone

Date Reached \$1,000: _____ Celebration: _____

Date Reached \$2,500: _____ Celebration: _____

Date Reached \$5,000: _____ Celebration: _____

Date Reached \$7,500: _____ Celebration: _____

Date Reached \$10,000: _____ Celebration: _____

What's Next?

Once you've reached \$10,000, the momentum continues. Set your next milestone—perhaps \$25,000 or \$50,000. The principles remain the same: consistency, diversification, and patience. Your wealth is building, and your partnership is stronger for it.

Your first \$1,000 invested changes everything.

Not because of the money — because of what it proves. That you're investors now. That this is real. That the plan is working. Complete this worksheet before you invest dollar one.

STEP 1 Find your \$1,000

Where is this first \$1,000 coming from?

- ☐ Current savings already set aside
- ☐ Reducing one monthly expense by \$ _____
- ☐ Monthly transfer of \$ _____ over _____ months
- ☐ Tax refund / bonus

Target date to have \$1,000 ready:

Date: _____

STEP 2 Choose where to invest it

Use the investment priority ladder. Where does your first \$1,000 go?

- ☐ Roth IRA — tax-free growth
- ☐ 401(k) up to employer match — free money first
- ☐ Brokerage account — flexible, no limits
- ☐ Emergency fund top-up first (if under 3 months)

Our \$1,000 is going to:

Account name: _____

STEP 3 Choose your first investment

For most beginners, a total market index fund or target-date fund is the best starting point.

Fund or ETF we're buying first:

e.g. VTI · FZROX · Target Date 2055

Why we chose it:

Write here...

STEP 4 Set up automation

The first \$1,000 is the hardest. After that, automation keeps you investing monthly.

Monthly auto-invest amount:

\$_____ per month

Transfer date (payday works best):

e.g. 1st of each month

WE COMMIT TO INVESTING OUR FIRST \$1,000 BY: Partner 1 signature:

Partner 2 signature:

Date

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Keep the Conversation Going

Investing is a journey, not a destination. Continue to use your Money Date Conversation Deck to ensure your financial decisions remain aligned with your shared values and dreams.

Regular check-ins, transparency, and mutual support are the cornerstones of successful couples' investing. The most powerful tool in your investment arsenal is consistency.

Keep learning. Keep contributing. Keep growing together.

Couples Investment Starter Kit · OurSteady.com · Digital Edition



You're building wealth. *Now protect and sustain it.*

The Investment Kit grows the house. Here's the full ecosystem that keeps it standing.

INVESTMENT LAYER — ALREADY YOURS

FREE

Money Date Starter Kit

The ritual that keeps both of you aligned on the investment journey.

✓ INCLUDED

\$37

Investment Starter Kit

Build your first investment strategy together — beginner to confident.

✓ YOU HAVE THIS

TRACK WHAT YOU'RE BUILDING

\$9

Couples Wealth Tracker

Track investments, net worth, and progress month by month. 19-page system.

→ ESSENTIAL PAIR

BUILD THE FULL PLAN

\$7

Money Scripts Cheat Sheet

Exact words for the 5 hardest money conversations.

ADD ON

\$17

Wealth Blueprint Workbook

6 modules: budget, invest, debt, goals, protect, 12-month roadmap.

WORKBOOK

\$37

90-Day Financial Reset Kit

Clear the clutter and rebuild before you scale.

STRATEGY

DEEPEN THE RELATIONSHIP LAYER

✦ The Connection Kit

\$67 bundle

- Money Date Conversation Deck — guided prompts for every money date
- Money Personality System — understand how your partner thinks about money
- Life Admin & Legacy Vault — protect everything you're building

UNLOCKS VIA EMAIL — AFTER PURCHASE

\$47

Couples Wealth Accelerator

12-month implementation system — the engine that sustains the strategy.

✉ VIA EMAIL

\$97

Couples Wealth Blueprint — Video Modules

6 guided video modules + all workbooks. The full course experience.

✉ VIA EMAIL

INVEST + TRACK = THE FULL PICTURE

The Wealth Tracker (\$9) captures your investment progress month by month. The pair every serious couple needs.

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